

L004: Cold Call Openers & Discovery Questions

Free Practice Sheet | @ondutyenglish | oabuilds.io/practice/L004

Lane C — Sales & Business English

Section 1 — Key Vocabulary

1. cold call

/koʊld kɔ:l/ noun/verb

A sales call made to a prospect who has not previously expressed interest.

"She made fifty cold calls before landing her first appointment."

Tagalog: tawag sa hindi pa kilalang kliyente

2. prospect

/ˈprɒspekt/ noun

A potential customer who fits your target profile.

"We identified twenty high-value prospects in the MENA region."

Tagalog: potensyal na kliyente

3. pain point

/peɪn pɔɪnt/ noun

A specific problem or challenge the prospect is experiencing.

"Our discovery call revealed that their main pain point was slow invoice processing."

Tagalog: pangunahing problema ng kliyente

4. gatekeeper

/ˈgeɪtˌkiːpər/ noun

A person who controls access to the decision-maker.

"The receptionist was the gatekeeper — I needed to get past her first."

Tagalog: tagapigil ng access sa desisyon

On Duty English

5. value proposition

/ˈvæljuː ,prɒpəˈzɪʃən/ noun phrase

A clear statement of the benefit your product or service provides.

"Our value proposition is a 30% reduction in onboarding time."

Tagalog: halaga ng iyong alok sa kliyente

6. objection

/əbˈdʒɛkʃən/ noun

A concern or reason the prospect gives for not buying.

"The most common objection we hear is 'we already have a solution.'"

Tagalog: tutol / pagtutol ng kliyente

7. follow-up

/ˈfɒləʊ ʌp/ noun/verb

A subsequent contact made after an initial interaction.

"I'll send you a follow-up email with the proposal by Friday."

Tagalog: susunod na pakikipag-ugnayan

8. pipeline

/ˈpaɪp,laɪn/ noun

The set of active deals at various stages of the sales process.

"Our pipeline has grown by 40% this quarter."

Tagalog: listahan ng mga aktibong deal

Section 2 — Phrases & Patterns

The reason for my call today is...

State your purpose clearly.

"The reason for my call today is to understand how your team handles client onboarding."

I was hoping to speak with...

Navigate past the gatekeeper.

"I was hoping to speak with the person responsible for procurement."

What's your biggest challenge with...?

Discovery question to uncover pain points.

"What's your biggest challenge with your current invoicing process?"

On Duty English

Many of our clients in your industry tell us...

Build credibility and relevance.

"Many of our clients in your industry tell us that manual reporting is their number one time drain."

Section 3 — Scenario Practice

Read the dialogue aloud. Circle any words you found difficult to pronounce.

Sales Rep: Good afternoon, this is Maria calling from Nexus Solutions. May I speak with your Head of Operations?

Gatekeeper: Can I ask what this is regarding?

Sales Rep: Of course. The reason for my call is to understand how your team currently manages supplier invoicing — we work with several logistics firms in your region.

Gatekeeper: One moment, I'll transfer you.

Decision Maker: Hello, this is James.

Sales Rep: Hi James, thank you for taking my call. I'll be brief — what's your biggest challenge with your current invoice approval process?

Decision Maker: Honestly? It takes us about two weeks to approve a single invoice. It's a real pain point.

Sales Rep: That's exactly what I was hoping to explore. Many of our clients in logistics tell us the same thing. Would you be open to a fifteen-minute call this week?

Section 4 — Self-Evaluation

After completing the exercises, tick each item you feel confident about:

I can open a cold call professionally without sounding scripted.

I can navigate past a gatekeeper using polite, confident language.

I can ask at least three discovery questions to uncover pain points.

I can state a value proposition clearly in one sentence.

Section 5 — My Notes

On Duty English

Lessons developed using AI-assisted production with reviewed industry vocabulary sources. © On Duty English | @ondutyenglish | oabuilds.io